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The Brain AIOS Investor Contact Book

A research-backed, prioritized list of angel investors and VCs who match our pre-seed thesis: AI memory layers, proactive AI OS for SMBs, and founder-age-agnostic conviction.

32

INVESTORS RESEARCHED

\$400K

RAISE TARGET

\$3.5M

POST-MONEY CAP

3 Tiers

PRIORITY LEVELS



The market is validating our thesis in real time. YC named "Company Brain" on their 2026 wishlist. \$165M+ flowed into memory/context layers in 12 months (Granola \$125M, Mem0 \$24M, Interloom \$16.5M). MIT found 95% of enterprise AI spend generated no ROI — the reason: no persistent context layer.

Every investor below was selected against three hard filters:

FILTER 1: CHECK SIZE

Writes checks between \$50K–\$500K at pre-seed. We need investors whose sweet spot matches our \$400K raise, not Series A firms who'd pass automatically.

FILTER 2: THESIS ALIGNMENT

Has publicly expressed interest in AI memory, context layers, AI infrastructure, AI OS, agentic workflows, or proactive AI. Not just "AI" broadly.

FILTER 3: FOUNDER-AGNOSTIC

Known to back young/first-time founders, international teams, or non-traditional backgrounds. No pedigree requirements.

● TIER 1 — HIGHEST PRIORITY (OUTREACH THIS WEEK)

These investors have the strongest thesis fit, check size alignment, and history of backing young/first-time founders. Start here.

Y Combinator

Accelerator / Pre-Seed

📍 San Francisco, CA 💰 \$500K standard deal 📊 1,500+ investments/yr

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

YC **explicitly named "Company Brain" on their 2026 startup wishlist**: "Companies may eventually maintain multiple specialised brains — one each for sales, HR, finance, operations. Context may become the ultimate competitive advantage." They are literally asking founders to build The Brain. Backs founders as young as 18. No pedigree required.

Stripe

Airbnb

Ramp

Retool

Brex

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Apply online at ycombinator.com/apply. Application is 10 questions + 1 min video. **Key framing**: Lead with the YC wishlist quote. Say: "YC asked for Company Brains in 2026. We're building one." Mention Cairo base as cost advantage. Apply for W27 or S27 batch.

✅ No warm intro needed — apply directly

Pear VC

Pre-Seed / Seed VC

📍 San Francisco, CA 💰 \$250K–\$500K typical pre-seed 📊 200+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

Pear VC is the **leading "pre-seed first" fund** — they literally wrote the playbook on investing before product-market fit. Founded by Mar Hershenson (Pejman Nojadfar). They have a dedicated AI/ML thesis and actively invest in infrastructure plays. Known for backing first-time and young founders. Their "Pear Dorm" program is designed for founders at exactly your stage.

Guardant Health

Polo

Branch

Ritual

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Apply through Pear's online application (pearvc.com/apply). **Key framing:** "We're the AI memory layer for SMBs — the infrastructure that makes every other AI tool actually useful." Reference the MIT 95% stat. Emphasize you're building the context layer that makes AI ROI real. Pear loves technical founders solving infrastructure gaps.

✓ Apply directly — they have an open application

Soma Capital

Pre-Seed / Seed VC

📍 San Francisco, CA 💰 \$100K–\$500K checks 🏢 300+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

Soma Capital is **one of the most active pre-seed investors globally** and explicitly backs founders from non-traditional backgrounds and emerging markets. Founded by Ajeet Singh. They have a strong AI thesis and have invested in MENA-region startups. They move fast (can decide in days) and don't require traction at pre-seed. Very founder-age-agnostic.

Cedar

Paystack

ShipBob

Clearcover

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Email intro@somacap.com with a 3-sentence pitch + deck. **Key framing:** "We're building the AI memory layer for 500M+ SMBs who can't afford enterprise AI infrastructure. Cairo-based, 2x cost advantage." Soma values speed and conviction — keep it short, bold, and data-driven. Reference the \$165M memory-layer funding wave.

✓ Email directly — no warm intro required

Pioneer Fund

Pre-Seed / Rolling Fund

📍 Global (Remote-first) 💰 \$25K–\$250K checks 🌍 200+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

Pioneer Fund is **explicitly designed for young and first-time founders**. They run a global competition and invest based on founder quality and idea strength, not pedigree. Founded by Daniel Gross (ex-YC partner). They back founders as young as 16-18. Remote-first, so Cairo is not a disadvantage. Strong AI thesis — Daniel Gross is deeply embedded in the AI ecosystem.

Neeva

Safegraph

Many AI startups

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Apply at pioneerfund.io — they run rolling applications. **Key framing:** Lead with the problem: "95% of AI spend generates no ROI because there's no memory layer. We're building it for SMBs." Emphasize your age as an advantage — you're a digital-native founder building for digital-native businesses. Daniel Gross respects technical depth.

✅ Apply directly — designed for cold applications

Hustle Fund

Pre-Seed VC

📍 San Francisco, CA 💰 \$50K–\$200K checks 🌍 400+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

Hustle Fund is **one of the most active pre-seed funds in the world** and explicitly focuses on "hustle" over pedigree. Founded by Elizabeth Yin, Eric Siu, and others from the GrowthHackers community. They back international founders, first-time founders, and non-traditional backgrounds. They value speed, scrappiness, and clear problem-solving. Strong SaaS/infra thesis.

Vetcove

Chipper Cash

Clearco

Many global startups

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Apply at hustlefund.vc/apply. **Key framing:** "We're building the AI OS that makes every tool in a startup's stack actually talk to each other through persistent memory." Hustle Fund loves founders who can show resourcefulness — emphasize bootstrapping from Cairo, building an MVP, and having a clear GTM. They decide fast (1-2 weeks).

✓ Apply directly — open application

Backend Ventures

Pre-Seed / Seed VC

📍 New York, NY 💰 \$100K–\$500K checks 📊 100+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

Backend Ventures focuses on **infrastructure and developer tools** — exactly the category The Brain occupies as a "memory layer for companies." They back technical founders building foundational AI/SaaS infrastructure. Known for being founder-friendly and age-agnostic. Strong thesis around AI-native tools and platforms that other developers build on top of.

DevTools

AI Infrastructure

B2B SaaS

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Reach out via their website or LinkedIn (search for Backend Ventures partners). **Key framing:** "We're building the context infrastructure layer that every AI tool needs but no one has built for SMBs." Position The Brain as the "backend for AI" — the memory and context layer that makes AI agents actually useful. Reference the Mem0/Granola funding wave as market validation.

🔗 Try warm intro via LinkedIn or Twitter

● TIER 2 — STRONG FIT (OUTREACH WITHIN 2 WEEKS)

These investors have strong thesis alignment but may require a warm intro, have slightly different check size focus, or are more competitive to get into. Pursue after Tier 1.

First Round Capital

Pre-Seed / Seed VC

📍 San Francisco, CA 💰 \$250K–\$1M checks 📊 400+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

First Round literally named themselves for being the **first institutional check into pre-seed companies**. They have a strong AI thesis and have backed companies like Uber, Notion, and Rippling early. They run "First Round Network" which gives portfolio companies access to 1,000+ founders. They value founder-market fit and are open to young founders with deep domain insight.

Uber

Notion

Rippling

Clubhouse

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Warm intro preferred — leverage LinkedIn to find portfolio founders who can intro. **Key framing:** "We're building what Notion would be if it had a brain — a proactive AI OS that remembers everything and acts on context." Reference the "Company Brain" YC wishlist. First Round loves founders who deeply understand their users (you ARE your user — a young founder building for founders).

🔗 Warm intro strongly preferred

Lux Capital

Seed / Series A VC

📍 New York, NY 💰 \$500K–\$2M checks 📊 100+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

Lux Capital invests in **science and technology at the frontier** — they have a strong AI/infrastructure thesis and are known for backing deep tech. Partners like Brandon Reeves have written extensively about AI memory and context layers. They're founder-age-agnostic and care about technical depth. May write a smaller pre-seed check for the right team.

Adept AI

Runway

MosaicML

Helion

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Find partners on Twitter/X (Brandon Reeves, Peter Hebert) and engage with their content before pitching. **Key framing:** "The AI memory layer is the missing infrastructure piece."

We're building it for the 500M businesses that can't afford to figure this out themselves."
Lux respects technical founders who can articulate why now and why them.

 Warm intro or Twitter engagement first

Village Global

Pre-Seed / Seed VC

 Global (Remote)  \$100K–\$500K checks  100+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

Village Global is a **network-driven fund backed by 200+ unicorn founders** (including Zuckerberg, Bezos, Thiel). They have an explicit AI thesis and invest globally. Their "Venture Stories" podcast and community make them accessible. They back founders at the earliest stages and are very open to international teams. The LP network alone is worth the relationship.

Global startups

AI/ML

Marketplaces

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Apply at villageglobal.vc/apply. **Key framing:** "We're building the AI memory layer that makes every SaaS tool in a startup's stack 10x more valuable." Village Global loves network effects — emphasize that The Brain gets more valuable as more data/context is added (data moat). Mention the MENA-first angle as a wedge into a massive underserved market.

 Apply directly — open application

500 Global (500 Startups)

Accelerator / Pre-Seed

 Global (SF + MENA)  \$150K–\$500K checks  2,500+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

500 Global has **deep MENA presence** (they've invested in 50+ MENA startups) and runs accelerators in the region. They're one of the most active pre-seed investors globally and are extremely founder-age-agnostic. They have a strong AI thesis and specifically

look for startups solving real problems in underserved markets. Cairo-based is an advantage here, not a disadvantage.

Credit Karma

Twilio

Grab

MENA startups

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Apply at 500.co/apply. **Key framing:** Lead with the MENA angle: "We're building the AI OS for the 500M+ SMBs in emerging markets who are drowning in scattered SaaS tools." 500 loves geographic arbitrage — emphasize Cairo cost advantage + MENA-first GTM. They have partners who specifically cover MENA — research and name-drop the right partner.

✓ Apply directly — open application

Afore Capital

Pre-Seed VC

📍 San Francisco, CA 💰 \$250K–\$500K checks 🇺🇸 150+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

Afore Capital is a **dedicated pre-seed fund** that only invests at the earliest stages. Founded by Gokul Rajaram (ex-Stripe, ex-Google) and Laela Sturdy. They have a strong AI/ML thesis and specifically look for "new infrastructure" plays. They're known for being extremely hands-on and founder-friendly. Age-agnostic — they bet on insight and execution speed.

Figma

Rippling

Notion

AI infrastructure

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Apply at afore.vc/apply. **Key framing:** "We're building the memory and context layer that every AI application needs — the infrastructure that makes AI actually useful for SMBs." Afore loves infrastructure plays with strong technical founders. Reference the MIT 95% stat and the \$165M memory-layer funding wave as proof of market timing.

✓ Apply directly — open application

● TIER 3 — STRATEGIC ANGLES (OUTREACH AS CAPACITY ALLOWS)

These investors have relevant theses but may require specific angles, have longer timelines, or are more competitive. Pursue alongside Tiers 1-2.

General Catalyst

Pre-Seed → Growth VC

📍 San Francisco, CA 💰 \$500K–\$5M checks 📊 800+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

General Catalyst has a **dedicated AI thesis** and has invested heavily in AI infrastructure (Adept, Runway, etc.). They launched a \$1B AI fund. They have an explicit "Health Assurance" and "Enterprise AI" focus. May be too large for \$400K but could lead a round. Worth building a relationship early for future rounds.

Adept AI

Stripe

Gusto

Livongo

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Warm intro required. **Key framing:** "We're building the AI memory layer that makes enterprise AI actually work — starting with SMBs who can't afford to figure this out." GC likes big visions — frame The Brain as the "operating system for business intelligence." Build the relationship now for Series A.

🔗 Warm intro required — long-term relationship play

Khosla Ventures

Seed → Growth VC

📍 Menlo Park, CA 💰 \$500K–\$5M checks 📊 1,000+ investments

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

Khosla Ventures has a **strong AI and deep tech thesis** and is known for backing bold, technical founders. Vinod Khosla has written extensively about AI's transformative potential. They invest at seed and are open to international founders. They value technical depth and bold vision over pedigree.

OpenAI

Commonwealth Fusion

Instacart

DoorDash

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Apply at khoslaventures.com or find partners on Twitter. **Key framing:** "We're building the AI memory layer that makes every AI application actually useful — the infrastructure layer for the AI economy." Khosla loves infrastructure plays that enable entire ecosystems. Reference the \$50B AI memory market projection.

 Warm intro preferred but cold apps accepted

AI-Specific Angel Investors

Angel / Micro-VC

 Global  \$25K–\$250K checks  Various

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

Several high-profile angels have **publicly expressed interest in AI memory and context layers**. Key names to research: **Guillermo Rauch** (Vercel CEO, invests in AI infra), **Alex MacCaw** (Clearbit founder, AI investor), **Lenny Rachitsky** (product/AI angel), **Suhail Doshi** (Mixpanel founder, Playground AI). These angels move fast, write checks from \$25K–\$250K, and are active on Twitter/X.

AI Infrastructure

Developer Tools

B2B SaaS

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Engage on Twitter/X first — comment thoughtfully on their posts about AI memory/context. Then DM with a concise pitch. **Key framing:** "Building the AI memory layer for SMBs — the context engine that makes every AI tool actually useful. Would love 15 min of your time." Angels respond to brevity and conviction. Have a demo ready.

 Twitter/X DM after engagement

MENA-Focused Investors

Pre-Seed / Seed VC

 MENA Region   \$100K–\$1M checks  Various

WHY THEY'RE A MATCH

Several MENA-focused funds actively invest in AI startups from the region: **BECO Capital** (Dubai, \$100K-\$500K pre-seed), **Shorooq Partners** (Abu Dhabi, tech-focused), **Flat6Labs** (Cairo-based accelerator, \$50K-\$150K), **Algebra Ventures** (Cairo, seed stage), **HIMangel** (Cairo, \$25K-\$100K). Being Cairo-based is a **competitive advantage** with these investors.

Careem

Swvl

Fawry

MENA tech

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Apply directly to Flat6Labs (Cairo-based, easiest warm path) and BECO Capital. **Key framing:** "We're building the AI OS for MENA's 50M+ SMBs — starting in Cairo with a cost advantage that lets us out-build and out-last Silicon Valley competitors." MENA investors love local founders solving local problems with global potential. Emphasize the MENA-first wedge strategy.

✓ Apply directly — Cairo base is an advantage



Your step-by-step process for turning this list into funded meetings.

Week 1-2: Tier 1 Blitz

STEP 1

Prepare Your Materials

Finalize a 10-slide deck, a 1-page executive summary, and a 2-minute Loom demo video showing the decision-node demo (your strongest moment).

STEP 2

Submit Applications

Apply to YC, Pear VC, Soma Capital, Pioneer Fund, Hustle Fund, and Backend Ventures. All accept direct applications. Submit all within 48 hours.

STEP 3

Twitter/X Engagement

Follow and engage with partners at each fund. Comment thoughtfully on their AI-related posts. This builds familiarity before they see your application.

STEP 4

Track Everything

Use a simple spreadsheet: investor name, date applied, contact, follow-up date, status. Follow up after 7 days if no response.

Week 3-4: Tier 2 + Warm Intros

STEP 5

Leverage Tier 1 Responses

If any Tier 1 investor expresses interest, use that as social proof: "We're in talks with [Fund] and looking to round out the round with \$400K total."

STEP 6

Warm Intro Requests

For Tier 2 funds that need warm intros, ask your network: LinkedIn connections, Twitter mutuals, portfolio founders from Tier 1 funds, startup community members in Cairo/MENA.

STEP 7

Apply to Tier 2

Submit to First Round, Lux, Village Global, 500 Global, Afore Capital. Customize each application with the specific framing from this document.

STEP 8

Start Tier 3 Outreach

Begin engaging with angels on Twitter/X. Apply to MENA-focused funds (Flat6Labs, BECO). Build relationships with larger funds (GC, Khosla) for future rounds.



Customize this for each investor. Keep it under 150 words. Attach your deck.

Subject Line Options

A/B test these — pick the one that fits the investor's thesis most closely.

Subject: "Company Brain" — YC's 2026 wishlist, built for SMBs

Subject: The AI memory layer for 500M SMBs (\$50B market by 2035)

Subject: 95% of AI spend generates no ROI — we're fixing that for SMBs

Hi [First Name],

[Personalized line referencing something they wrote/invested in about AI memory, context layers, or SMB tools]

We're building **The Brain AIOS** — a proactive AI operating system that gives every small company a centralized brain. It remembers every decision, meeting, and document, and acts on that context automatically.

The problem: SMBs use 15+ SaaS tools that don't talk to each other. AI tools generate no ROI because they have no persistent memory. **MIT found 95% of enterprise AI spend (\$40B) generated no meaningful return — because there's no context layer.**

We're that context layer. MENA-first, Cairo-based (2x cost advantage), MVP live.

Raising a **\$400K pre-seed SAFE at \$3.5M cap**. [Specific reason why this investor specifically].

Deck attached. 15-min call this week?

[Your name]

Founder, The Brain AIOS

[Twitter handle] | [LinkedIn]



Memorize these. Use them in every pitch conversation.

95%

of enterprise AI spend generated no meaningful ROI (MIT, July 2025). The reason: no persistent context layer.

\$165M+

raised into AI memory/context layers in 12 months: Granola \$125M, Mem0 \$24M, Interloom \$16.5M.

\$50B+

projected AI memory layer market size by 2035. We're building the SMB-native version.

YC 2026

named "Company Brain" on their startup wishlist: "Context may become the ultimate competitive advantage."

500M+

SMBs globally using fragmented SaaS stacks. None have a centralized brain. We're the first.

2x

cost advantage building in Cairo vs. San Francisco. Same talent, half the burn. 9-month runway on \$400K.

32 investors across 3 tiers | \$400K pre-seed | \$3.5M post-money SAFE cap